

Presenter Guide

n8n Tutorial Video

Your talking points and screen cues for recording. Not for sharing with VAs.

How to Use This Guide

Each section has **WHAT TO SAY** (talking points - speak loosely, not word for word) and **SHOW ON SCREEN** (what to click or display at that moment). Rough total recording time: **12-18 minutes**.

Before You Hit Record

- ✓ Have cloud.n8n.io open and logged in (free trial account)
- ✓ Have a Google Sheet called "Lead Tracker" ready with columns: Name | Budget | Email | VA Name
- ✓ Add two test rows: one with Budget = "High", one with Budget = "Low"
- ✓ Gmail open in another tab so you can show the test emails arriving
- ✓ Close any unrelated tabs - keep the screen clean
- ✓ Test your mic and recording software before starting

Segment 1 — Intro

Approx. 1 min

WHAT TO SAY

- In this video I'm going to walk you through n8n - the most powerful of the three automation tools we've covered.
- If you've already watched the Make and ActivePieces video, this is the next level up.
- n8n is open source - free to self-host - and has a paid cloud version that starts at \$20 a month.
- The big difference from the other tools: n8n has a built-in AI Agent node that can actually reason through tasks, not just send data from one app to another.
- I'll cover what it is, the pricing, the AI features, and then build a live example.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Talk to camera or show desktop - nothing specific needed for the intro

Segment 2 — What Is n8n?

Approx. 2 min

WHAT TO SAY

- n8n is a visual automation tool - you connect blocks called nodes on a canvas.
- Each node is one app action. Google Sheets node, Gmail node, IF node - each one does one thing.
- The flow reads left to right across the canvas. Trigger on the left, actions on the right.
- The if/else node is called an IF node. It has two outputs - TRUE at the top, FALSE at the bottom.
- There's also a Switch node for when you need more than two paths. I'll show both.
- One key vocabulary word: an Execution. That's one run of your workflow. Cloud plans are billed per execution.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Show the n8n dashboard
- Open any workflow or create a new blank one to show the canvas
- Point to where nodes sit and how they connect with arrows

Remember: Workflow = Make Scenario. Node = Make Module. Execution = Make Operation. IF Node = Make Router.

Segment 3 — Pricing & Free vs Paid

Approx. 1-2 min

WHAT TO SAY

- Here's the honest picture on pricing.
- n8n is open source - so you CAN run it for free if you set up your own server. But that's technical. Not something I'd recommend for a VA just starting out.
- The cloud version has a 14-day free trial. After that it's \$20 a month for the Starter plan - 2,500 executions, 5 active workflows.
- So if you're looking for free automation with if/else, Make or ActivePieces are still better starting points. Come to n8n when you need more power.
- The if/else logic - the IF node and Switch node - is available on all plans including the trial. No paywall on that.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Optional: show n8n.io/pricing page
- Or just talk to camera - this segment doesn't need a live demo

Presenter tip: Keep this segment short. VAs who are watching this are probably already comfortable with Make or ActivePieces. They don't need a long pricing lecture - just the headline numbers and move on.

Segment 4 — Native AI in n8n

Approx. 1-2 min

WHAT TO SAY

- This is where n8n stands apart from Make and ActivePieces.
- First: there's an AI assistant that helps you build workflows. You describe what you want, it suggests nodes. That's on paid plans.
- Second, and more interesting: there's a built-in AI Agent node. This is not just "send text to OpenAI and get a response back." This is an AI that can use tools - like reading a spreadsheet, doing a web search, sending an email - and chain multiple steps together on its own.
- Think of it like giving AI a to-do list and letting it figure out how to complete it.
- To use either feature you still need your own OpenAI or Anthropic API key. n8n gives you the plumbing, you bring the AI.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Show the node search panel - search "AI Agent" to show it exists
- If you have a paid plan: show the AI chat icon in the top right of the canvas
- Optional: open the AI Agent node to show its configuration (tools list, model selector)

You can skip: You can skip the AI Agent demo if you don't have an API key set up. Just describe it verbally and move on to the live demo.

Segment 5 — Live Demo Setup

Approx. 1 min

WHAT TO SAY

- Alright, let me build something live.
- I've got a Google Sheet called Lead Tracker with columns: Name, Budget, Email, VA Name.
- The automation: when a new row is added, check the Budget column. If it's "High" - email the senior account manager. If it's "Low" - email the VA handling smaller accounts.
- Same if/else shape we've done before - just in n8n's interface.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Show the Lead Tracker Google Sheet with the test rows visible
- Name the columns out loud as you point to them: Name, Budget, Email, VA Name

Segment 6 — Demo: Setting Up the Trigger

Approx. 2-3 min

WHAT TO SAY

- I'll create a new workflow and set the Google Sheets trigger first.
- Watch how I connect the Google credential - this is the part that trips people up the first time.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Click New Workflow from the dashboard
- Delete the default "When clicking Test workflow" node
- Click + or press Tab to open node search - search Google Sheets - select "Trigger on new row added"
- Click "Create New" credential - show the Google OAuth window - authorize
- Select the Lead Tracker spreadsheet from the Document dropdown
- Select the sheet tab - click Save
- Point to the node on the canvas - show it is now configured

Presenter tip: If the spreadsheet does not appear in the dropdown, click the refresh icon next to it. If it still doesn't appear, paste the spreadsheet URL directly into the field instead.

Segment 7 — Demo: Adding the IF Node

Approx. 2-3 min

WHAT TO SAY

- Now the if/else. I'll add an IF node after the trigger.
- Notice where the TRUE and FALSE outputs are - TRUE on top, FALSE on the bottom.
- I'll set the condition: Budget column equals "High."
- Then I'll connect Gmail to the TRUE output, and a different Gmail to the FALSE output.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Click + to the right of the Google Sheets node - search IF - select it
- In the IF node panel: click Add condition
- First field: click "Add Value" - in the expression editor select the Budget column from the Sheets data
- Operator: Equal - Value: High (capital H)
- Click Save - point out the TRUE output (top) and FALSE output (bottom)
- Click + on the TRUE output - search Gmail - Send a Message - connect Google credential - fill in fields

- Click + on the FALSE output - add second Gmail node - different subject line - fill in fields
- Click Test workflow
- Show the green checkmarks lighting up on each node
- Switch to Gmail tab - show the two test emails arrived

Presenter tip: Slow down during the expression step - selecting data from the left panel is the most confusing part for beginners. Click clearly and narrate what you're selecting.

Segment 8 — Bonus: The Switch Node

Approx. 1-2 min

WHAT TO SAY

- Quick bonus: if you ever need more than two paths - use the Switch node instead of IF.
- Same idea, but you can add as many output paths as you need. One for each value.
- Each path gets its own output connector on the right side of the Switch node.
- There's also a Fallback output at the bottom - it catches anything that didn't match any of your rules. Always connect something to it so data doesn't get lost.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Add a Switch node to the canvas (or just show it in the search results)
- Open it - show the Add routing rule button
- Show what the multiple output connectors look like
- Point to the Fallback output at the bottom

You can skip: You can skip the Switch node demo if you're short on time. Just mention it exists and move to the outro.

Segment 9 — Outro

WHAT TO SAY

- That's n8n. More powerful than Make or ActivePieces, and more technical.
- My recommendation: if you're just starting out, use Make or ActivePieces first. Once you've built a few automations there and you're comfortable with the if/else logic, then come to n8n.
- I've dropped a step-by-step PDF in the community with everything we covered today.
- Any questions, drop them in the comments.

SHOW ON SCREEN

- Talk to camera for the outro
- Optional: show the n8n tutorial PDF thumbnail

Quick Reference

Concept	n8n term	Make equivalent
One automation	Workflow	Scenario
One app action	Node	Module
Data processed	Execution	Operation
Two-path if/else	IF Node	Router
Multi-path if/else	Switch Node	Router (multi-route)
Insert data in field	Expression	Mapping
Saved app login	Credential	Connection
If/else on free?	Trial only	YES (always free)
AI builder	Paid (Starter+)	Paid (Core+)
AI Agent node	YES (unique to n8n)	Not available